

Word family: **knot / knots / knotted / knotting / knotty**

Base word: knot

Part of speech: mainly **noun** and **verb**

Related forms:

* **knot** (n.) — 結；結節；一團糾纏；緊張感

* **knot** (v.) — 打結；纏結；使糾結

* **knotted** (adj./participle) — 打了結的；糾纏的

* **knotty** (adj.) — 多結的；棘手的；難解的

* **knotting** (n.) — 打結；結繩

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **tie a knot**

* **undo / untie a knot**

* **a knot in a rope**

* **a knot in your stomach**

* **a knot in your throat**

* **hair in knots**

* **muscles in knots**

* **tie the knot**

* **get tied up in knots**

* **knot together**

* **knotted muscles**

* **knotty problem**

* **knot** as a speed unit at sea/aviation

Meaning in this passage

> For a moment, I just froze and felt **a knot in my stomach**.

Here, **a knot in my stomach** is figurative.

It means:

a tight, uncomfortable feeling in the stomach caused by anxiety, shock, or emotional stress
— 因緊張、震驚或不安而胃裏一緊；心裏揪住

The speaker had just been accused unfairly in front of the group, so the emotional shock produced a strong physical sensation.

中文翻譯：

那一刻我整個人有點愣住，心裏也像**打了一個結一樣**。

So here:

a knot in your stomach = 因緊張、害怕、難過或壓力而感到胃部像收緊一樣的不舒服感

1. **knot (繩結；結) — 結**

This is the core literal sense.

Practice 1

> He tied a **knot** in the rope.

他在繩子上打了一個**結**。

Practice 2

> The **knot** was difficult to untie.

那個**結**很難解開。

Practice 3

> She pulled the **knot** tighter.

她把那個**結**拉得更緊。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****knot = 繩、線、帶等互相纏繞形成的結****

2. **tie a knot — 打結**

Practice 1

> Can you **tie a knot** in this string?

你可以在這條繩上**打個結**嗎？

Practice 2

> He ****tied a knot**** to secure the bag.

他****打了一個結****把袋固定好。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****tie a knot = 把繩、線等交叉纏繞形成一個結****

3. ****untie / undo a knot — 解開結****

Practice 1

> I couldn't ****untie the knot****.

我解不開那個****結****。

Practice 2

> She slowly ****undid the knot****.

她慢慢把那個****結解開****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****untie/undo a knot = 把已纏繞形成的結解開****

4. ****knot (頭髮 / 線纏成一團) — 糾結 ; 打結****

Practice 1

> My hair is full of ****knots****.

我的頭髮滿是****打結的位置****。

Practice 2

> There was a ****knot**** in the cable.

電線有一處****纏結****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****knot = 頭髮、繩線等纏在一起形成的難解糾結****

5. **hair in knots — 頭髮打結**

Practice 1

> Her hair was **in knots** after the windy walk.

吹完風後，她的頭髮**打成一團**。

Practice 2

> Use conditioner if your hair gets **in knots** easily.

如果頭髮很容易**打結**，可以用護髮素。

MCQ-ready definition:

hair in knots = 頭髮互相纏繞，難以梳開

6. **knot (肌肉繃緊的硬結) — 肌肉硬結；結節**

Practice 1

> I have a **knot** in my shoulder.

我的肩膀有一個**肌肉硬結**。

Practice 2

> The massage helped loosen the **knot** in my back.

按摩幫助放鬆背部的**緊繃硬結**。

MCQ-ready definition:

muscle knot = 肌肉局部持續緊繃，感覺像有一個硬塊或結

7. **muscles in knots — 肌肉繃得很緊**

Practice 1

> My shoulders were **in knots** after the stressful meeting.

那場壓力很大的會議後，我的肩膀**繃得很緊**。

Practice 2

> Stress can leave your muscles ****in knots****.

壓力可以令肌肉****緊得像打了結一樣****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****muscles in knots = 肌肉因壓力或緊張而非常繃緊****

8. ****a knot in your stomach — 胃裏一緊；心裏揪住****

This is the exact expression used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> I felt ****a knot in my stomach****.

我感到胃裏****像打了一個結一樣****。

Practice 2

> I always get ****a knot in my stomach**** before interviews.

面試前我總會****緊張到胃裏一緊****。

Practice 3

> The bad news left her with ****a knot in her stomach****.

那個壞消息令她****心裏揪住、胃部發緊****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****a knot in your stomach = 因焦慮、害怕、震驚或壓力而產生的胃部緊縮感****

9. ****a knot in your throat — 喉頭哽住****

A related emotional idiom.

Practice 1

> I felt ****a knot in my throat**** when I said goodbye.

道別時，我感到**喉頭一緊 / 哽咽**。

Practice 2

> The speech left him with **a knot in his throat**.

那番演說令他**喉頭哽住**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****a knot in your throat = 因強烈情緒而感到喉嚨收緊、難以說話****

10. **tie the knot — 結婚**

A very common idiom.

Practice 1

> They **tied the knot** last summer.

他們去年夏天**結婚了**。

Practice 2

> The couple plans to **tie the knot** next year.

那對情侶計劃明年**結婚**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****tie the knot = informal: get married****

中文：

****結婚****

11. **get tied up in knots — 緊張得亂了；把事情搞得很複雜**

Practice 1

> He **got tied up in knots** trying to explain himself.

他越解釋越**緊張混亂**。

Practice 2

> Don't **tie yourself in knots** over a small mistake.

不要因一個小錯誤把自己弄得**焦頭爛額 / 過分糾結**。

MCQ-ready definition:

get/tie yourself in knots = 因緊張、過度思考或複雜問題而變得混亂

12. **knot (verb : 打結) — 打結**

Practice 1

> She **knotted the rope** tightly.

她把繩子**打了一個緊結**。

Practice 2

> He **knotted the scarf** around his neck.

他把圍巾在頸上**打結**。

MCQ-ready definition:

knot something = 把繩、布、線等打成結

13. **knot together — 綁在一起 ; 打結連接**

Practice 1

> **Knot the two ropes together**.

把兩條繩**打結綁在一起**。

Practice 2

> She **knotted the ends together**.

她把兩端**打結連起來**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****knot X together = 用打結的方式把兩個或多個東西連在一起****

14. ****knot (verb : 變得糾結) — 糾纏 ; 打結****

Practice 1

> My hair ****knotted**** in the wind.

我的頭髮被風吹得****打結****。

Practice 2

> The fishing line had ****knotted**** badly.

魚絲嚴重****纏結****了。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****knot = become tangled into one or more knots****

15. ****knotted (打結的 ; 糾結的) — 打結的****

Practice 1

> He pulled at the ****knotted rope****.

他拉着那條****打了結的繩****。

Practice 2

> Her hair was badly ****knotted****.

她的頭髮嚴重****打結****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****knotted = 已經形成一個或多個結 , 或糾纏在一起的****

16. ****knotted muscles — 繃緊成結的肌肉****

Practice 1

> Massage can help relax **knotted muscles**.

按摩可以幫助放鬆**繃緊的肌肉**。

Practice 2

> Stress left his shoulders **knotted**.

壓力令他的肩膀肌肉**繃成一團**。

MCQ-ready definition:

knotted muscles = 因緊張或用力而持續繃緊的肌肉

17. **knotty** (有很多結的) — 多結的

Literal adjective sense.

Practice 1

> The old wood was rough and **knotty**.

舊木材很粗糙，而且有很多**木節**。

Practice 2

> The tree has **knotty branches**.

這棵樹的樹枝有很多**節結**。

MCQ-ready definition:

knotty = containing many knots or hard rounded places, especially in wood

18. **knotty problem / issue** — 棘手難解的問題

A major figurative adjective use.

Practice 1

> This is a **knotty problem**.

這是一個**棘手難解的問題**。

Practice 2

> The team spent hours discussing the **knotty issue**.

團隊花了幾小時討論這個**複雜難解的問題**。

MCQ-ready definition:

knotty = complicated and difficult to solve or understand

中文：

複雜而棘手的

19. **knot** (木節) — 木節；木瘤

A common physical noun sense.

Practice 1

> There is a large **knot** in the wood.

這塊木材上有一個很大的**木節**。

Practice 2

> The board cracked around a **knot**.

木板在一個**木節**附近裂開。

MCQ-ready definition:

knot = 木材中樹枝曾經生長的位置所形成的硬圓節

20. **knot** (航海 / 航空速度單位) — 節

A completely separate technical sense.

Practice 1

> The ship was travelling at twenty **knots**.

船以二十**節**航行。

Practice 2

> The wind speed reached forty **knots**.

風速達到四十**節**。

MCQ-ready definition:

knot = 航海及航空常用速度單位，相當於每小時一海里

21. **at X knots** — 以 X 節速度

Practice 1

> The boat was moving at fifteen **knots**.

小艇以十五**節**速度航行。

Practice 2

> The aircraft was travelling at several hundred **knots**.

飛機以數百**節**速度飛行。

MCQ-ready definition:

at X knots = 以每小時 X 海里的速度移動

Important distinction 1: **knot** vs **bow**

knot

general fastening created by intertwining material.

bow

a specific decorative/functional looped knot.

> tie a knot

打結

> tie a bow

打蝴蝶結

Important distinction 2: **knot vs tangle**

knot

more compact and often has a recognizable tied structure.

tangle

general messy entanglement.

> a knot in the rope

繩上一個結

> a tangle of wires

一團糾纏的電線

Important distinction 3: **knot vs lump**

knot

may describe tight muscle or wood structure.

lump

general solid bump or mass.

A muscle **knot** emphasizes tightness, while a **lump** can have many other causes.

Important distinction 4: **a knot in your stomach vs stomach pain**

stomach pain

literal physical pain.

a knot in your stomach

usually emotional/figurative tightness caused by anxiety or fear.

The sensation can feel physical, but the phrase points to the emotional cause.

Important distinction 5: ****a knot in your stomach vs butterflies in your stomach****

****a knot in your stomach****

stronger, tighter, often unpleasant anxiety or distress.

****butterflies in your stomach****

nervous excitement; can be positive or negative.

Before a date:

> butterflies

After a public accusation:

> a knot in your stomach

Your passage clearly suits ****knot****.

Important distinction 6: ****a knot in your throat vs lump in your throat****

These are very close.

****a lump in your throat****

much more common for being close to tears.

****a knot in your throat****

also conveys emotional tightening, though less common.

Both refer to strong emotion making speech difficult.

Important distinction 7: ****tie the knot is not literal****

> They tied the knot.

usually means:

他們結婚了

not that they literally tied rope.

Context matters.

Important distinction 8: **tie yourself in knots**

This often has two related ideas:

Emotional

become extremely worried or tense.

Intellectual

make an explanation/problem unnecessarily complicated.

> He tied himself in knots trying to justify it.

他越解釋越亂。

Important distinction 9: **knotty = physical vs figurative**

Physical

> knotty wood

多木節的木材

Figurative

> knotty problem

棘手複雜的問題

Same metaphor: something full of “knots” is hard to work through.

Important distinction 10: **knot** = 木節 vs tree knot

The wood sense refers to the hard area where a branch grew from the trunk.

It is not a rope knot.

Important distinction 11: **knot** as speed unit

A **knot** already means:

one nautical mile per hour

So avoid saying:

> **knots per hour** ❌

Standard:

> 20 knots ✅

because “per hour” is already built into the unit.

Important distinction 12: **knot** vs nautical mile

nautical mile

distance unit.

knot

speed unit.

> 10 nautical miles

distance

> 10 knots

speed

Family-extension note

****Knot**** has several strong modern branches:

1. ****literal tied structure****

- * tie a knot
- * untie a knot

2. ****tangled material****

- * hair in knots
- * knotted rope

3. ****physical tightness****

- * muscle knot
- * knotted muscles

4. ****emotional tightness****

- * knot in your stomach
- * knot in your throat

5. ****marriage idiom****

- * tie the knot

6. ****mental/emotional complication****

- * tie yourself in knots
- * knotty problem

7. ****wood****

- * knot in wood

8. ****speed measurement****

- * 20 knots

The emotional metaphor is especially useful:

> ****something physically tied tight → body feels emotionally tight****

That is exactly what happens in your passage.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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knot	結	tied structure
tie a knot	打結	create knot
untie a knot	解結	undo knot
hair in knots	頭髮打結	tangling
knot in a cable	電線纏結	entanglement
muscle knot	肌肉硬結	physical tightness
muscles in knots	肌肉繃緊	tension
knot in your stomach	胃裏一緊；心裏揪住	anxiety
knot in your throat	喉頭哽住	strong emotion
tie the knot	結婚	marriage idiom
tie yourself in knots	緊張得亂 / 過分糾結	confusion/anxiety
knot (verb)	打結；糾結	form a knot
knot together	打結綁在一起	join
knotted	打結的；糾纏的	tied/tangled
knotted muscles	繃緊的肌肉	muscle tension
knotty (literal)	多結的	many knots
knotty problem	棘手問題	hard to solve
knot (wood)	木節	branch scar
knot (speed)	節	nautical speed unit
at 20 knots	以 20 節速度	speed

For your original sentence

> For a moment, I just froze and felt **a knot in my stomach**.

Here:

a knot in my stomach = 因為突然被公開而且不公平地指責，緊張、震驚和難受得胃部像縮成一團

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 那一刻我整個人有點愣住，心裏也像**打了一個結一樣**。

Or, if we want to preserve the physical sensation more directly:

> 那一刻我整個人愣住了，**胃裏突然一緊**。

The first is more expressive; the second is more semantically exact.